

Chris Ross, MBA, CHRL

Toronto, ON • 647-231-9786 • CR.ChrisRoss@gmail.com • [Portfolio](#) • [LinkedIn](#)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Senior HR leader with 15+ years advising executive teams in regulated industries - automotive financial services, global corporate and investment banking, and insurance. Track record building HR infrastructure that scales with business growth: large-scale **Workday deployment**, **entity restructuring**, and **total rewards transformation**. Combines operational depth across payroll, total rewards, and workforce analytics with strategic partnership at the executive and committee level.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategic & Executive

Executive HR Advisory · Workforce Planning · Org Design · M&A & Entity Restructuring · Succession Planning

Total Rewards & Governance

Compensation Strategy · Pension Governance · Payroll Operations · Compliance & Audit (PwC, EY, OSFI, FINTRAC, IIROC)

Systems & Analytics

Workday Deployment · HRIS Implementation · Workforce Analytics · Process Automation (Python, VBA, Power Query, APIs)

SELECTED TRANSFORMATION HIGHLIGHTS

- **14-Country Workday Deployment.** Canada country lead on simultaneous global rollout - configuration, data migration, change management, and go-live across complex multi-jurisdiction program (MUFG).
- **Entity Conversion - Subsidiary to Branch.** HR operations and payroll lead through structural conversion that unlocked balance sheet access; portfolio scaled from \$2.5B to \$40B+ during tenure (MUFG).
- **Total Rewards Restructuring.** Led market benchmarking and program redesign across automotive financial services, delivering \$700K in annual savings while preserving market competitiveness (BMW).
- **Canadian Quant Risk Build-Out.** Deployed low-cost geo strategy and built a new quantitative risk division from scratch - 25+ specialized hires in 12 months servicing New York and San Francisco trading floors (MUFG).
- **HR & Payroll Automation Stack.** Architected Python, VBA, Power Query, and API integrations across payroll and operations - 50%+ efficiency gain, eliminating manual reconciliation (BMW).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BMW Group Canada

Toronto, Canada

Automotive & Financial Services

Manager, HR Planning & Steering

Nov 2024 – Present

Scope: BMW, MINI, and Rolls-Royce Canadian operations | 300+ associates | \$40M HR budget | Multi-provincial payroll (ON, QC, BC, AB)

- Own total rewards governance across three brands - compensation, bonus structures, pension, and payroll - calibrating market position against WTW, AON, and Mercer benchmarks while maintaining internal equity and local + global regulatory alignment.
- Reduced operating expenses \$1.2M through workforce cost analysis and headcount discipline; reframed monthly variance reporting to give senior leadership a forward-looking view rather than retrospective.

- Architected payroll and operations automation stack (Python, VBA, Power Query, API integrations) - improving cycle efficiency 50%+ and eliminating manual reconciliation across providers.
- Manage \$40M HR budget across multiple planning cycles, including personnel cost forecasts, operating expenses, and variance tracking.
- Lead audit readiness with PwC and EY; strengthened reporting frameworks, policy structures, and governance controls.
- Chair, Canadian Pension Committee - accountable for fiduciary governance, plan design, and member outcomes.
- Chair, AI Ambassador leadership team - driving AI literacy, peer training, and adoption across HR and adjacent functions.

Manager, Human Resources Business Leader

2020 – Nov 2024

Scope: Senior HR advisor to Sales and Finance leadership | 400+ associates across Canada, US, and Japan | Multi-entity structure

- Reframed total rewards across Canadian operations: led market benchmarking, built the business cases, and restructured the program - delivering \$700K in annual savings without compromising market competitiveness.
- Reduced voluntary turnover 10%+ through targeted leadership development and engagement interventions; built the executive case for sustained investment.
- Lifted engagement scores 15% over four years to the highest in the region using Qualtrics-based action planning tied to measurable leader objectives.
- Owned the Canadian COVID relief program end-to-end, securing \$3.5M+ in government subsidies.
- Led pension carrier transition and asset transfer, consolidating services and creating a unified associate experience.
- Drove development talks, succession planning, and key talent initiatives across a multi-entity, multi-jurisdiction population.
- Standardized policies and processes across entities to support scalable HR delivery.

Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group

Toronto, Canada

Global Corporate & Investment Banking

AVP, Regional HR Business Partner

2018 – 2020

Scope: Regional HR partner to Corporate Banking, Investment Banking, Securities, and Risk | 400+ associates | Four legal entities | Regulated by OSFI, FINTRAC, IIROC

- Built the Canadian quantitative risk division from scratch - deployed a low-cost geo strategy and onboarded 25+ specialized quants in 12 months to service New York and San Francisco trading floors.
- Directed annual compensation and payroll cycles for 400+ associates across four legal entities in a tightly regulated environment.
- Partnered directly with OSFI, FINTRAC, and IIROC stakeholders on compliance and operational readiness; coordinated cross-functionally with Legal and Compliance.
- Led talent reviews and succession planning across multiple entities, surfacing development plans for the regional executive team.
- Supported integration and consolidation work during a period of significant M&A activity.

Human Resources Manager

2012 – 2018

Scope: Canada HR operations through entity conversion and major growth phase | Portfolio scaled \$2.5B → \$40B+ during tenure

- Served as Canada country lead for a simultaneous 14-country Workday deployment - coordinated configuration, data migration, change management, and go-live across a complex global program.

- Managed HR operations and payroll oversight through subsidiary-to-branch entity conversion that unlocked balance sheet access and enabled Canadian commercial expansion.
- Led ADP-to-Ceridian payroll transition, strengthening controls and standardizing documentation.
- Built and refined HR and payroll control frameworks to keep pace with rapid portfolio growth.

AEGON Canada
Global Insurance

Toronto, Canada

Employee Experience and Brand Lead

- Led employer brand and onboarding transformation for a global insurance carrier.

2009 – 2010

EDUCATION

MBA , Wilfrid Laurier University	2016 – 2019
Bachelor of Commerce (HR Major) , Toronto Metropolitan University	2010 – 2012
Business Administration Diploma (HR & Accounting) , Durham College	2007 – 2010

DESIGNATIONS

Certified Human Resources Leader (CHRL)	2014
National Payroll Institute (NPI) - Member	2020
Insights Discovery Accredited (IDA) Certified Trainer	2018

SYSTEMS & TECHNICAL

HRIS & Payroll: Workday, SuccessFactors, Ceridian, ADP
Analytics & Reporting: Power BI, Tableau, Advanced Excel, Python, SQL
Project & Collaboration: Microsoft Suite, Visio, Jira, Asana, Confluence, SharePoint, GitHub
AI Tools: Microsoft Copilot, Claude, OpenAI (incl. Codex), open-source models